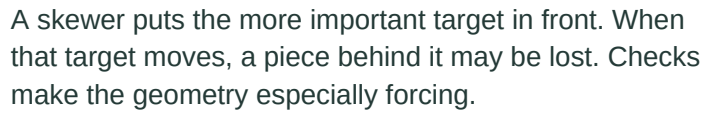


Skewers

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on d5. Geometrically undefended: rook on d8. Check for tactical protection.

Previous move: 32...Kd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

33. Rd1+ Kxc5 34. Rxd8

33.Rd1+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **33...Kxc5**.

34.Rxd8 The rook captures the rook on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.